AYO TOMORI

PRODUCT LEAD | PRODUCT OWNERSHIP | PRODUCT DISCOVERY & STRATEGY

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PROFILE

Product lead with experience across product ownership, discovery, strategy, UX and digital delivery in telecommunications, SaaS, government, healthcare and enterprise. At Vodafone UK, I owned the vision, roadmap and backlog for a scalable design-system product, leading a team of four across product, design and engineering. My experience spans B2B SaaS propositions, strategic roadmaps and taking digital products from concept to delivery.

Combining UX expertise, early development experience and customer insight, I bridge customer needs, business goals and technology. I enjoy solving complex problems, turning ideas into valuable products and leading cross-functional teams from opportunity to outcome. I leverage AI to prototype, automate workflows and validate ideas faster.

CORE PRODUCT CAPABILITIES

Product Strategy & Ownership: Product vision · Product discovery · Problem definition · Roadmapping · Backlog management · Prioritisation · Product requirements · Hypothesis-driven development · Stakeholder alignment

Discovery & Validation: User research · Customer journeys · Competitive analysis · Prototyping · Usability testing · Design sprints · Concept validation · Design thinking

Delivery & Technology: Agile delivery · Engineering collaboration · Sprint planning · Design systems · Accessibility · Technical constraints and trade-offs · HTML/CSS · Figma

AI & Emerging Technology: AI-assisted prototyping and product building · Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) · Workflow automation · AI fluency and responsible adoption · Rapid concept validation

Leadership: Cross-functional leadership · Stakeholder management · Workshop facilitation · Team leadership · Mentoring · Presentations and storytelling

SELECTED PRODUCT EXPERIENCE

VMD Legacy Product

Lead UX Consultant | CGI

- Helped redefine the experience of a legacy product within significant technical constraints, balancing customer needs, accessibility and engineering feasibility.
- Identified improvements that avoided an unrealistic technical rebuild, and evaluated product and design trade-offs with the team.
- Shaped a solution that reduced engineering effort while improving accessibility and time to task completion compared with the existing experience.

AI Knowledge Assistant (RAG) — Groww

- Defined product scope and requirements for an AI-powered mutual fund knowledge assistant.
- Designed a RAG-based solution using LLMs and prompt engineering to retrieve information from verified financial sources.
- Structured factual Q&A flows covering mutual fund fees, scheme features, risk levels and documentation.
- Defined citation, response-length and safe-refusal rules to improve accuracy, transparency and responsible AI behaviour.
- Incorporated privacy-by-design principles, excluding sensitive personal data and preventing investment advice.

Vodafone UK Design System

Product Owner / Design Lead

- Led the vision and development of a scalable design-system product for Vodafone UK, addressing limitations, inconsistencies and duplication in the existing Vodafone Group design libraries.
- Defined the product and technical vision and established principles for a scalable, reusable product.
- Owned the backlog and roadmap for core library capabilities, aligning priorities across design, product and engineering.
- Audited existing components and engaged designers and developers to identify pain points, redundancies and opportunities.
- Benchmarked established design systems to inform product direction and structure.
- Worked with engineering through planning, implementation and iteration to keep solutions technically viable and scalable.

- Led rollout, documentation, training and governance to drive adoption across teams.
- Managed and mentored a team of four designers and facilitated cross-functional workshops.
- **Outcome:** reduced technical debt and improved component usage efficiency by approximately 15%.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CGI

2022–2026

Lead UX Consultant — VMD Legacy Product

- Helped redefine the experience of a legacy product within significant technical constraints, balancing customer needs, accessibility and engineering feasibility.
- Collaborated across design and engineering to translate customer and business needs into feasible product improvements, reducing engineering effort while improving accessibility and time to task completion.

Senior UX Consultant — Home Office

- Worked with Product Owners, Business Analysts, architects and engineers to develop a secure internal application.
- Translated user and organisational needs into product and experience solutions in a complex stakeholder environment.
- Delivered an initial work package against agreed milestones, with positive stakeholder feedback.

Service Designer — HMRC

- Shaped the end-to-end journey for a new service proposition aligned with organisational objectives.
- Developed journey maps to explore and communicate the proposed service, and built a proof of concept to bring it to life.

BT — UX/UI Designer

2022

- Supported development of a new B2B SaaS proposition for BT clients.
- Ran user research and explored interaction patterns, user flows and trade-offs to address customer pain points and business goals.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams on the design and development of new features.

Merck & Co — UX Designer

2021–2022

- Assessed existing design processes through stakeholder interviews and analysis of current ways of working.
- Identified opportunities to improve UX maturity and developed a strategic roadmap aligned with business objectives and primary-care initiatives.
- Worked with stakeholders to set priorities and improve how product and design decisions were made.

Vodafone — Lead Designer & Product Owner

2018–2020

- Led the design and technical vision of Vodafone UK's component design system.
- Managed the product backlog and roadmap for core library features, and facilitated sprint planning with Product Owners and engineering.
- Reported progress to stakeholders, ran workshops and onboarded designers into the UX chapter.
- Managed a team of four designers while advocating for user-centred and accessible product experiences.

EARLIER DIGITAL PRODUCT EXPERIENCE

Self-Employed / Freelance — Product & Digital Designer / Developer
2006–2018

- Delivered digital products, eCommerce experiences and campaigns across retail, travel, financial services, media and technology.
- Covered product design, digital development, prototyping, HTML/CSS and client management, taking projects from concept through delivery.
- Developed and operated a fashion brand, gaining hands-on experience of entrepreneurship, marketing and leadership.

Estée Lauder Companies — Corporate Design Assistant
2003–2006

- Worked with key stakeholders on promotional visuals and product illustration for Clinique, Aramis, DKNY and Tommy Hilfiger.

EDUCATION

- **Product Manager Fellowship**, Next Leap · 2026
- **UX Design Immersive Certification**, General Assembly, London · 2015
- **BA Multimedia Arts**, SAE Institute, London · 2000–2002
- **A Levels:** Economics, Mathematics & Computing, Newham College, London · 1998–2000

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

Design & prototyping: Figma · Google Stitch · Adobe XD · Sketch · UserZoom
AI-assisted build & deploy: Claude Code · Cursor · OpenCode · Git · Render · HTML/CSS
Automation & AI workflows: n8n · RAG · AI agents · LLMs · Prompt engineering · Machine learning fundamentals · Observability & AI evals · AI fluency